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BBB WISE GIVING ALLIANCE

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April 29, 2019

John McPhail
President and Chief Executive Officer
Partners of the Americas
1424 K Street NW, Suite 700
Washington, DC 20005

Dear Mr. McPhail:

Thank you for providing us with information that allowed us to amend our previous conclusions. I have enclosed a copy of the final report on Partners of the Americas showing that it meets all Standards.

In the future, if you have any questions or concerns, please do not hesitate to contact me at 703-247-9386 or via e-mail at hparker@give.org.

Sincerely,

Holly Parker
Charity Research Analyst

Enclosure

3033 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 710 Arlington, VA 22201-3866 703.247.9321

BBB Wise Giving Report for
Partners of the Americas

BBB Wise Giving report *issued* May 2019.
BBB Wise Giving report *expires* May 2021

This BBB Accredited charity meets all 20 Standards for Charity Accountability.
Find out more...

Find out more about this charity:

- Charity Contact Information
- BBB Wise Giving Alliance Comments
- Programs
- Tax Status
- Governance
- Fund Raising
- Financial

Interested in supporting the work of the BBB Wise Giving Alliance?
Make a donation now

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Charity Contact Information

Name:	Partners of the Americas
Address:	1424 K Street NW, Suite 700 Washington, DC 20005
Phone:	202-628-3300
Web Address:	http://www.partners.net

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BBB Wise Giving Alliance Comments

Year, State Incorporated: 1963, District of Columbia

Affiliates: 97 chapters

Stated Purpose: "to connect people and organizations across borders to serve and change lives through lasting partnerships."

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Evaluation Conclusions

Partners of the Americas (POA) meets the 20 Standards for Charity Accountability.

Programs

POA reports that it works with its local chapters and partners in 30 countries to provide food security, education, job training, and eliminate child labor. The organization's agriculture programs work to connect rural farmers with agribusinesses to increase employment and food production and address malnutrition. POA states that its higher education programs offer knowledge and skills for employment by connecting higher education institutions across borders to exchange knowledge, build programs, and foster long-term partnerships in the western hemisphere. The organization also partners with the US Department of State to distribute capacity building grants to create and expand the capacity of US higher education study abroad programs globally. POA reports that its programs to combat child labor work to create income-generating opportunities for families by providing direct educational and livelihood services and improve labor law enforcement and working conditions. In 2017, the organization states that it distributed $1.3 million in grants, trained 166,000 individuals to help rural farmers and agribusiness in Latin America, and worked in Costa Rica to enforce minimum wage laws and documented the scope of child labor and labor violations in Colombia's coffee trade.

For the year ended December 31, 2017, POA's program expenses were:

Youth and education	4,584,806
Agriculture and environment	1,988,990
Partners of the Americas Foundation	412,587
Exchanges and fellowships	273,059
Total Program Expenses:	$7,259,442

Governance

Chief Executive : John R. McPhail, President and Chief Executive Officer
Compensation*: $160,000

Chair of the Board: Harry E. Wing
Chair's Profession / Business Affiliation: President of Peru Chapter, Partners of the Americas

Board Size: 14

Paid Staff Size: 21

*2017 compensation, as reported by the charity, includes annual salary and, if applicable, benefit plans, expense accounts, and other allowances.

Note: POA reports that John McPhail began his tenure as President and Chief Executive Officer on June 6, 2017.

Fund Raising

Method(s) Used:

Grant proposals, Internet appeals, cause-related marketing, and membership appeals.

Fund raising costs were less than 1% of related contributions. (Related contributions, which totaled $14,773,658, are donations received as a result of fund raising activities.)

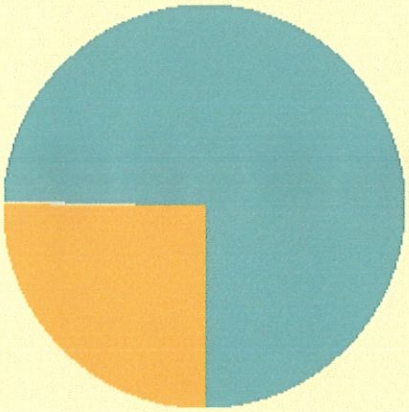
Tax Status

This organization is tax-exempt under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code. It is eligible to receive contributions deductible as charitable donations for federal income tax purposes.

Financial

The following information is based on POA's audited financial statements - combined - for the year ended December 31, 2017.

Source of Funds	
US government grants	12,185,714
In-kind contributions	2,287,780
Other grants and contributions	266,501
Other income	195,496
Interest and investment income	107,038
Fee for service	77,384
Membership dues	33,968
Individual contributions	33,663
Total Income	**$15,187,544**



Uses of Funds as a % of Total Expenses

Programs: 75% **Fund Raising:** Less than 1% **Administrative:** 25%

Total income	$15,187,544
Program expenses	$7,259,442
Fund raising expenses	24,720
Administrative expenses	2,455,209
Total expenses	$9,739,371
Income in Excess of Expenses	5,448,173
Beginning net assets	7,601,647
Ending net assets	13,049,820
Total liabilities	1,305,672
Total assets	$14,355,492

Note: According to POA's audited financial statements - combined - for the year ended December 31, 2017, the organization received $2,287,780 in donated labor.

An organization may change its practices at any time without notice. A copy of this report has been shared with the organization prior to publication. It is not intended to recommend or deprecate, and is furnished solely to assist you in exercising your own judgment. If the report is about a charity and states the charity meets or does not meet the BBB Standards for Charity Accountability, it reflects the results of an evaluation of information and materials provided voluntarily by the charity. The name Better Business Bureau is a registered service mark of the Council of Better Business Bureaus, Inc.

This report is not to be used for fund raising or promotional purposes.

What is the BBB Wise Giving Alliance?
The BBB Wise Giving Alliance (BBB WGA) is a 501(c)(3) public charity that serves as the charity reporting arm of the Better Business Bureau system. BBB WGA works to help the public identify trustworthy national charities by evaluating them rigorously in relation to the holistic *BBB Standards for Charity Accountability*. The organizations that formed BBB WGA have been producing reports on charities for nearly 100 years.

Does the BBB report on local charities as well?
While BBB WGA's focus is on nationally-soliciting charities, about 57 of the over 100 local Better Business Bureaus report on regionally soliciting charities.

What does it cost for filing and evaluation?
There is no charge for the accreditation evaluation.

How will filing information with the BBB WGA benefit a charity?
One of our goals with the charity evaluation process is to help strengthen charity practices. Our holistic *Standards for Charity Accountability* cover a wide range of topics that go beyond the financial ratios and formulas. Charities who work with us to meet all of our *Standards* are fulfilling expectations many donors have about the organizations they give to. In addition, the public, including media, can access the resulting reports at Give.org, one of the most frequently visited donor information sites in the nation.

Who developed the *Standards for Charity Accountability*?
A panel of advisors with a range of experience in philanthropy worked over a three-year period in an open process, issuing drafts and soliciting input from the public and the charitable community before publishing the standards.

How can we get an idea of how the BBB WGA applies its standards?
Click on the "How We Accredit Charities" box at Give.org for details on the BBB WGA's application of each standard.

What will happen to the information a charity provides?
BBB WGA will prepare a draft BBB Wise Giving Report in relation to its *Standards for Charity Accountability*, and, after the draft is sent to the organization for review and comment, BBB WGA will make a final report available to the public at Give.org

Could a charity amend the report, if it doesn't agree with what it says?
We welcome any information from a charity that might affect the content and conclusions of our report. Findings can be amended at any time after a report has been published if the charity provides documentation of changes.

Who says that a charity must adhere to the BBB WGA standards?
The Standards are *voluntary*. They go beyond what the law requires. Most charities, in our experience, operate well within the law. But just being law-abiding isn't likely to attract public support. Donors want to see that charities are ready, *voluntarily*, to show their commitment to openness and ethical conduct.

What is the BBB Charity Seal?
If a charity is found to meet all 20 of the BBB Charity Standards (i.e. a BBB Accredited Charity), it has the option of licensing a BBB charity seal for a sliding scale fee which can be placed on the charity's website and appeals.

BBB STANDARDS FOR CHARITY ACCOUNTABILTY

4 PILLARS & 20 STANDARDS TO VERIFYING A TRUSTWORTHY CHARITY

GOVERNANCE

The governing board has the ultimate oversight authority for any charitable organization. This section of standards seeks to ensure that the volunteer board is active, independent and free of self-dealing.

1. **BOARD OVERSIGHT**
   Adequate oversight of the charity's operations and its staff.
2. **BOARD SIZE**
   Minimum of five voting members.
3. **BOARD MEETINGS**
   Minimum of three meetings per year.
4. **BOARD COMPENSATION**
   No more than one or 10% directly or indirectly compensated person(s) serving as voting member(s).
5. **CONFLICT OF INTEREST**
   No material conflicting interest transaction(s) with board or staff member(s).

RESULTS REPORTING

These standards require that charities set defined, measurable goals and objectives, evaluate their success based on them, and identify ways to address deficiencies.

6. **EFFECTIVENESS POLICY**
   Board policy of assessing, no less than every two years, the organization's performance and effectiveness and of determining future actions required to achieve its mission.
7. **EFFECTIVENESS REPORT**
   Written report on charity's performance and effectiveness submitted to board for approval.
8. **PROGRAM EXPENSES**
   At least 65% of total expenses spent on program activities.
9. **FUNDRAISING EXPENSES**
   < 35% of related contributions spent on fundraising.
10. **ACCUMULATING FUNDS**
    Avoids accumulating funds that could be used for current program activities.

FINANCES

This section of standards seeks to ensure that the charity spends its funds honestly, prudently and in accordance with statements made in fundraising appeals.

11. **AUDIT REPORT**
    Makes available to all, on request, complete annual financial statements prepared in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles.
12. **DETAILED EXPENSE BREAKDOWN**
    Financial statements that shows what portion of the expenses were allocated to program, fundraising, and administrative activities.
13. **ACCURATE EXPENSE REPORTING**
    Accurately reports the charity's expenses, including any joint cost allocations, in its financial statements.
14. **BUDGET PLAN**
    Annual budget for current fiscal year showing expense totals for programs, fundraising, and administration.

TRUTHFUL & TRANSPARENT

This section of standards seeks to ensure that a charity's representations to the public are accurate, complete and respectful.

15. **ACCURATE MATERIALS**
    All Solicitations and informational materials, are accurate, truthful and not misleading.
16. **ANNUAL REPORT**
    Annual report that is available to all.
17. **WEBSITE DISCLOSURES**
    Soliciting charities must include on their website:
    - Annual report details
    - Mailing address
    - Electronic access to recent IRS Form 990
18. **DONOR PRIVACY**
    Addresses privacy concerns of donors.
19. **CAUSE MARKETING DISCLOSURES**
    Clearly disclose how the charity benefits from the sale of products or services that state or imply that a charity will benefit from a consumer sale or transaction.
20. **COMPLAINTS**
    Responds promptly to and acts on complaints brought to its attention by the BBB Wise Giving Alliance and/or BBBs.

CHARITY REPORTS INCLUDE THESE SYMBOLS

✓	✗	!
MEETS STANDARDS	STANDARDS NOT MET	DID NOT DISCLOSE

MEET THE STANDARDS, EARN ACCREDITATION

BBB ACCREDITED CHARITY

give.org

Learn more about our standards and to see which charities have met our standards at **Give.org**. Follow us **@bbb_give**.